state, group of states or international organizations to manufacture or otherwise acquire any of the agents, toxins, weapons, equipment or means of delivery specified in Article I of the Convention.

6. ***Strategic Arms Limitation Talks (SALT I):*** These refer to efforts made by the two superpowers to ease off the Cold War tensions and enhance the spirit of détente by developing means of arms limitations. SALT I froze the number of strategic ballistic missile launchers at existing levels, and provided for the addition of new Submarine Launched Ballistic Missile (SLBM) launchers only after the same number of older intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) and SLBM launchers had been dismantled.

After a long deadlock, the first results of SALT I came in May 1971 when an agreement was reached over ABM systems. The Agreement included: (a) the Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty and (b) the Interim Agreement between the United States of America and the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics (now Russia) on Certain Measures With Respect to the Limitation of Strategic Offensive Arms.

The Treaty required both the countries to limit the number of sites protected by an anti-ballistic missile (ABM) system to two each. The Soviet Union had deployed such a system around Moscow in 1966 and the United States announced an ABM program to protect 12 ICBM sites in 1967. The Interim Agreement covered both land-based ICBMs and SLBMs. The USSR was permitted to have 1618 ICBMs while the number for USA was fixed at 1054 on the basis of their actual strength as on 1 July 1971.

7. ***Threshold Test Ban Treaty, 1974:*** The Treaty on the Limitation of Underground Nuclear Weapon Tests, also known as the **Threshold Test Ban Treaty** (or **TTBT**), was signed in July 1974 by the USA and the USSR. It established a nuclear ‘threshold’, by prohibiting nuclear tests of devices having an yield exceeding 150 kilotons (equivalent to 150,000 tons of TNT).

The TTBT was militarily important since it prohibited the possibility of testing new or existing nuclear weapons going beyond 150 kilotons. The Treaty imposed a mutual restraint and thereby sought to reduce the degree of explosive force of new nuclear warheads and bombs